Joe Cotten

IT Specialist and Data Analyst

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SUMMARY

Dedicated System Analyst with experience in maintaining multi-agency databases and ensuring compliance with HUD standards. Managed IT resources across five regional offices, resulting in operational continuity and resolved technical issues to improve statewide partner agency effectiveness. Seeking IT Specialist role to leverage skills in data integrity and technical support to enhance IT operations using comprehensive technical expertise.

EXPERIENCE

Systems Maintenance Technician

Yates Services, Canton, Mississippi | Jul 2026 to present

- Maintain the PCs on the assembly line at the Nissan manufacturing plant in Canton, Mississippi, so vehicles advance through the correct sequence numbers and workers can do their jobs without interruption.
- Support torque tools connected to light bars that confirm fasteners are driven to the correct torque spec.
- Maintain Dell Latitude tablets and scanners on forklifts and AGVs that confirm parts arrive at the correct location along their routes.
- Keep Zebra, VIN, and certification printers running, including reloading paper and supplies.

Director of Technology

Emmanuel Baptist Church, Macon, Mississippi | Mar 2023 to present

- Streamlined data management by deploying ChurchCRM on AWS with automated data collection for attendance and finance records, keeping them secure and accessible.
- Maintain documentation on system processes and provide technical support to address user issues.
- Configure and manage the infrastructure for a live stream every Sunday, using a network-attached 4K camera feeding OBS and streaming to YouTube, reaching viewers across a six-state area.
- Directed church-wide network upgrades that improved connectivity for administrative systems and supported expanded digital outreach; manage all networking equipment and cabling.

Systems Analyst

Mississippi United to End Homelessness, Jackson, Mississippi | Oct 2024 to Aug 2025

- Administered and maintained a multi-agency database, cleaning and validating thousands of records to maintain data integrity and meet HUD compliance standards.
- Generated and analyzed HUD-mandated reports using Excel and HMIS (Homeless Management Information System), on monthly, quarterly, and annual schedules, to inform federal and internal policy decisions.
- Built report templates that streamlined recurring reporting.
- Provided technical support and help desk services to partner agencies statewide, resolving data and hardware issues.
- Managed hardware and IT resources across five regional offices, ensuring operational continuity.

Consumer Protection Specialist I

Mississippi Department of Agriculture and Commerce, Jackson, Mississippi | Feb 2024 to Oct 2024

- Conducted on-site inspections and data collection at over 200 fuel stations, covering nearly 2,000 fuel pumps across a four-county area, to ensure accurate dispensing and regulatory compliance under state law.
- Recorded inspections in WinWam and issued violation reports to the state and to station owners; identified trends and anomalies through data analysis, leading to timely enforcement actions.
- Enforced compliance by red-tagging pumps, taking them out of service, when violations went unresolved after one week.
- Tested underground fuel tanks for water contamination and collected fuel samples from randomly selected stations every week.
- Communicated inspection results and required corrective actions to business owners and maintenance workers, and investigated consumer complaints.
- Maintained a self-directed inspection schedule, consistently meeting tight state deadlines.

Athletics Official

Mississippi High School Activities Association | Aug 2017 to present

- Travel to schools across the majority of Mississippi to officiate interscholastic athletic competitions.
- Enforce regulations to facilitate fair gameplay while maintaining a safe, respectful environment for student-athletes and coaches.
- Assess complex in-game scenarios to accurately interpret and apply rules, ensuring consistent enforcement.

EDUCATION

University of Southern Mississippi

Bachelor's degree, Information Technology (in progress) | Aug 2026 to present

Vanderbilt University

Certificate, Data Analytics | Nov 2023 to May 2024

Mississippi State University

Information Technology coursework | Aug 2019 to Dec 2022

Southwest Mississippi Community College

Associate of Arts, Computer Science | Aug 2017 to May 2019

SKILLS

Data: SQL, Python, Excel, HMIS, Data Analytics, Dashboards, Data Management, Data Engineering, Data Science, Algorithms, Data Collection, Data Entry

IT: IT Infrastructure, Technical Support, Networking, AWS, Live Streaming, OBS, Web Development, Computer Hardware, Computer Repair, Microsoft Office

Other: Public Speaking, Petroleum Products